

OPERATION HIMALAYAN SHIELD - OPERATION ORDER 07/2026

Reference: Northern Command Contingency Plan HS-2026. Time Zone Used Throughout the Order: INDIA STANDARD TIME (IST).

Task Organisation. 14 Mountain Brigade (main effort), reinforced by one mechanised infantry battalion, one medium artillery regiment (155mm), one combat engineer company, and one army aviation flight (utility and reconnaissance). 27 Signals Regiment provides area communications. Attached: one field surgical team and one forward logistics element.

1. SITUATION.

a. Enemy Forces. Opposing formations are assessed to hold prepared defensive positions along the northern approaches to the Leh sector at a strength of approximately two reinforced battalions, supported by dug-in anti-tank guided missile teams and dispersed mortar sections. Enemy air activity is assessed as limited to unmanned reconnaissance. Most likely enemy course of action is a mobile defence oriented on the two principal valley roads, trading space for time while attempting to canalise our advance into pre-registered artillery engagement areas. Most dangerous course of action is a spoiling attack against our assembly areas during the hours of darkness preceding H-Hour.

b. Friendly Forces. 3 Infantry Division continues the defence of the eastern sector and protects the right flank of this brigade. Corps artillery is prepared to deliver counter-battery fire on call. Higher intent is to secure the Leh axis, restore the integrity of the line of actual control in the assigned area, and establish conditions for a follow-on relief in place by 8 Mountain Division.

c. Attachments and Detachments. Effective from 0300 hours on D-1, the mechanised infantry battalion is attached to 14 Mountain Brigade. The combat engineer company reverts to divisional control on completion of the breach and passage of lines.

2. MISSION.

14 Mountain Brigade seizes and secures the dominating ground overlooking the northern approaches to the Leh sector not later than 0600 hours on D-Day, in order to deny the enemy

observation and direct fire onto the main supply route and to enable the forward passage of divisional reserves.

3. EXECUTION.

a. Commander's Intent. My intent is to close with the enemy along the western valley while fixing him in the east with deception and harassing fires. The decisive operation is the seizure of Objective FALCON by the main effort; supporting operations isolate the objective and secure the lines of communication. The end state is achieved when the dominating ground is under our control, the main supply route is protected from direct fire and observation, and the brigade is postured to hand over to the relieving formation without a pause in the defence.

b. Concept of Operations. The operation is conducted in three phases. Phase One, shaping, extends from D-2 to H-Hour and comprises reconnaissance, obstacle reduction, and the movement of forces to attack positions under cover of darkness and electromagnetic emission control. Phase Two, the decisive action, begins at H-Hour with a synchronised assault on Objective FALCON supported by preparatory artillery fires and close air support on call. Phase Three, consolidation, begins on seizure of the objective and includes reorganisation, casualty evacuation, resupply, and preparation for the relief in place.

c. Scheme of Manoeuvre. The main effort advances along the western axis with two assault battalions forward and one in depth. The mechanised battalion conducts a supporting attack along the eastern axis to fix the enemy and to protect the right flank. The reconnaissance flight screens the northern approaches and provides early warning of any enemy repositioning. Engineers reduce the linear obstacle at the valley mouth and mark two lanes for the passage of the mechanised force.

d. Fires. Priority of fires is to the main effort throughout. A programme of preparatory fires strikes identified command posts, mortar positions, and anti-tank teams from H minus fifteen minutes. Counter-battery fire is on call from corps artillery. Restrictions: no fires within one thousand metres of the marked cultural site at grid reference sector nine; all requests routed through the brigade fire support coordination cell.

e. Coordinating Instructions. H-Hour is confirmed by codeword THUNDERBOLT transmitted on the command net. Timings are relative to H-Hour unless stated otherwise. The rules of engagement in force are those promulgated for the exercise and remain in effect until formally rescinded. All units report crossing of phase lines using the designated checkpoints.

4. SERVICE SUPPORT.

a. Sustainment. The brigade maintenance area is established two kilometres south of the assembly area. Combat supplies are pushed forward on a daily maintenance cycle; two days of supply are held at unit level. Water is drawn from the divisional point and distributed by unit transport. Ammunition resupply during the decisive action is by pre-positioned caches at the attack positions.

b. Medical. The field surgical team is co-located with the brigade maintenance area. Casualty evacuation is by ground ambulance to the collection point and thence by air to the divisional hospital, weather permitting. Each battalion establishes a regimental aid post forward.

c. Transport and Movement. Movement forward is by unit vehicles along the designated route, staggered to preserve tactical dispersion. Traffic control points are manned by the provost detachment from D-1.

5. COMMAND AND SIGNAL.

a. Command. The brigade commander locates with the tactical headquarters on the western axis during the decisive action. Succession of command is the deputy commander, then the commanding officer of the leading assault battalion. Main headquarters remains in the assembly area.

b. Signal. Primary means of communication is secure combat net radio; alternate is line to fixed locations; contingency is dispatch rider; emergency is pyrotechnic signal per the signal instruction. Electromagnetic emission control state is amber until H-Hour, thereafter green. Codewords, nicknames, and the challenge and password for the period are issued separately under the signal instruction.

Acknowledge. Distribution is restricted to addressed headquarters and units only. This is a fictitious exercise document created solely to test data-leak-prevention fingerprinting and contains no real operational information.